

next year, she's going to take a gap year. Minimum. She might not go to college." She wants to pursue the entrepreneur route.

Many career paths offer high-paying jobs that do not require a college degree. We'll consider some alternatives to college later in this chapter.

The next thing that must be considered is the opportunity cost of going to college. When you decide to invest your time and money in college, you are deciding not to invest those resources elsewhere. If your goal is to reach FI quickly, does it make sense to give up four, six, or maybe twelve years of your life going to school? Is it prudent to dig a hole of debt when you need even more resources to dig yourself out? It very well may be if college enables a career you'll love for the next thirty to forty years. But too often, people spend four or more years of their lives and tens of thousands of dollars and come out with no discernible skills that will enable them to get a job. Even if you do obtain the skills that enable career success, there is still another cost to consider.

That next consideration is sunk cost. Consider how hard it is to change course once you invest the resources necessary to start down a particular path. How many people really know what they